



## PROGRESS REPORT

# AI: progress report, 2025-08-01 to 2026-08-28

Edition of 2026-08-28 · compiled by Claude Opus from the documents in the Corpus repository

3 places. Every table below is carried verbatim from that place's own progress report; nothing is written here.

AFRICA · SOUTHERN AFRICA · WEST AFRICA

**Movement values.** *Advanced* — a system entered service, a stage was completed or an instrument was made. *Stalled* — a stated target passed without delivery. *Regressed* — an instrument was withdrawn or neutralised, or a measured position worsened. *Closed* — the programme ended. *No change* — the position at both ends is the same. *Baseline not held* — the base carries no position at the start of the period, so no movement can be stated. A value may carry a qualifying clause after a comma, as in *Advanced, slipped*.

## Africa

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM                                       | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                               | AT 2026-08-28                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                 | MOVEMENT  |
|------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Africa AI Council                                                | Did not exist                                                                                                               | Established under a board of 42 heads of state with the AU Commissioner for Energy and Infrastructure and the ITU Secretary-General; no work programme or output held in the nine months since                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                | ADVANCED  |
| Free student access to a commercial assistant                    | Did not exist                                                                                                               | A technology company offered African students one year of its paid artificial-intelligence assistant tier at no charge, pitched at study materials, assignments and planning                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | ADVANCED  |
| Fund departmental paper on artificial intelligence in the region | Did not exist                                                                                                               | A departmental paper on the potential of artificial intelligence across sub-Saharan Africa, held in full as published                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | ADVANCED  |
| Pan-African AI governance research and advocacy project          | Did not exist                                                                                                               | A four-year research and advocacy project on pan-African AI governance, funded at EUR 1,873,314 and running 2026 to 2030, implemented by a consortium of a German university media research centre and three civil-society organisations; the position it argues from is common principles through continental institutions rather than 54 national AI regimes, covering data governance, AI ethics, procurement standards, regulatory sandboxes, cross-border research and capacity-building | ADVANCED  |
| Africa AI Fund                                                   | Announced in April 2025 at US\$60bn, alongside the Africa AI Declaration, with nothing capitalised                          | Still cited as one pillar of the continental AI architecture; no capitalisation, governance structure or disbursement held                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | NO CHANGE |
| AU Continental AI Strategy                                       | Adopted 2024-07-19 as the continental reference for national AI policy, on an implementation timeframe running 2025 to 2030 | Unchanged in text, and the reference the Commission carried into global forums; ministers meeting at the ECA called for its translation into national frameworks. The instrument's own timetable runs Phase I across 2025-2026, a midterm review in 2027 and Phase II from 2028                                                                                                                                                                                                               | NO CHANGE |

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM                                                                        | AT 2025-08-01                                                                                                                                           | AT 2026-08-28                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                    | MOVEMENT                 |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>Monitoring and evaluation of the AU Continental AI Strategy</b>                                | Provided for in the Strategy through an African AI readiness index, a public monitoring dashboard and regional AI observatories, with nothing published | Still nothing published; the Peace and Security Council requested the Commission and its AI Advisory Group to submit periodic reports on 2026-04-16, and the Strategy's own midterm review falls in 2027                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                         | NO CHANGE                |
| <b>Common African Position on AI and its Impact on Peace, Security, Democracy and Development</b> | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b>                                                                                                                                | The Council requested the Commission to expedite the comprehensive study and the Common African Position and submit them for its consideration; a Policy Brief on AI for Peace, Security and Governance in Africa is reported in progress and no text is published                                                                                                                                                                                               | <i>Baseline not held</i> |
| <b>Google Africa Applied AI Lab</b>                                                               | Did not exist                                                                                                                                           | A co-development programme based at the Accra AI Community Centre and run with the sponsor's AI futures fund, giving selected African startups from pre-seed to Series C+ pre-release access to its Gemini, Gemma and Veo models plus research mentorship and go-to-market support, with no equity taken and no cash award guaranteed; it closes with a demo day in Accra                                                                                        | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |
| <b>Public capital committed to the AU Continental AI Strategy</b>                                 | Baseline not held                                                                                                                                       | About US\$150m of public capital committed by African governments against an implementation cost the Strategy itself prices at between US\$250bn and US\$500bn - a fraction of one per cent - and an ambition to add US\$1.5 trillion to Africa's GDP by 2030; independent research over the Strategy's first eighteen months found the funding heavily concentrated in Kenya, Nigeria, South Africa and Egypt, with little reaching the remaining member states | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> |

## Southern Africa

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM                                                     | AT 2025-08-01            | AT 2026-08-28                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                              | MOVEMENT                 |
|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------|
| <b>COMESA regional AI strategy</b>                                             | Did not exist            | Stakeholder consultation held under the World Bank-supported IDEA programme to inform the strategy and its action plan; no draft, drafter or adoption route published                                                                                                                                                                                      | ADVANCED                 |
| <b>SADC Regional Artificial Intelligence Strategy and Regulatory Framework</b> | <b>BASELINE NOT HELD</b> | Under development according to Malawi's ICT ministry (2026-06); no draft, adoption date or Secretariat document held; a regional workshop at Harare on data governance in the artificial-intelligence age, convened with the World Bank, a continental alliance and a United Nations agency, set out to harmonise member states' data policy for readiness | <i>Baseline not held</i> |

## West Africa

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM                     | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-28                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                  | MOVEMENT           |
|------------------------------------------------|---------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------|
| <b>ECOWAS Regional AI Governance Framework</b> | Did not exist | Resolved to be developed, citing algorithmic bias, labour displacement and information disorder; no draft, drafting body or date held in the six months since; a four-country comparative study presented on 2026-08-10 found none of Benin, Senegal, Cote d'Ivoire or Burkina Faso holds AI-specific legislation in force or in draft, rating Cote d'Ivoire's strategy the most advanced of the four on inclusion and data governance and finding Burkina Faso's data-protection law the only one to name AI-based processing | ADVANCED, MARGINAL |

| BODY, INSTRUMENT OR SYSTEM                        | AT 2025-08-01 | AT 2026-08-28                                                                                                                                   | MOVEMENT |
|---------------------------------------------------|---------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|----------|
| Francophone West African AI governance guidelines | Did not exist | Adopted by Benin, Burkina Faso, Cote d'Ivoire, Guinea, Mali and Senegal; advisory, complementing national strategies rather than replacing them | ADVANCED |

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## ABOUT THIS DOCUMENT

|                 |                                                                                                                                                                                   |
|-----------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| EDITION         | 2026-08-28                                                                                                                                                                        |
| CURRENT EDITION | <a href="https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/topics/tech-ai/tech-ai-progress.html">https://corpus.data-landscapers.io/topics/tech-ai/tech-ai-progress.html</a>                     |
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Figures are dated because most are time-varying: a figure carries the date it was true, not the date you are reading it. Where the base holds no reliable statement, the document says **Not held** rather than leaving a silence — those are counted, and listed at the end.

This is a dated edition and is not revised after publication. If a figure here has moved, the current edition will say so.